

PLUG AND PLAY CHINA 璞跃中国

Cross-Border Acceleration Camp

SUMMER COHORT 2026 | NANTONG

Powered by NETDA · NID · NHIZ
Phase 1 & 2 Program Schedule | June 25 – August 28, 2026

Important — In-Person Attendance Required

The first two months of the program are essential and require the physical, in-person presence of at least one founding team member in Nantong throughout the entire period. Remote participation is not accepted for Phases 1 and 2. Please plan your travel, visa, and relocation arrangements well in advance and confirm your participation with the PnP team before booking.

PRE-ARRIVAL | June 25 – 30

All selected startups are required to arrive in Nantong between June 25 and June 30. This window is dedicated to settling in before the program officially kicks off on July 1st. The PnP team will coordinate your accommodation and provide all necessary arrival information in advance.

Pre-Arrival Checklist

1. Book your international flight, reimbursement up to USD 2,000 per startup (invoice and proof of payment required)
2. Notify Aboli of your intended arrival date before booking your flight, he will then coordinate your apartment rental contract
3. Your accommodation address in Nantong will be shared with you prior to arrival
4. Travel to Nantong from Shanghai: take the bullet train (high-speed rail) from Shanghai Hongqiao Station to Nantong west Station, fast, affordable, and easy. Refer to the China Living Handbook shared separately for step-by-step guidance
5. Download WeChat before landing, it is essential for all daily communication, payments, and navigation in China. Add Aboli directly: WeChat ID 15515532656
6. Complete the online pre-arrival orientation sent by the PnP team prior to your departure

WEEK 1

July 1 – 10

China Entry & Founder Orientation

Activities

1	Relocation & Settlement Support	<i>Jun 25 – Jul 2</i>	Full relocation assistance covering housing check-in, apartment setup, office arrangement, city orientation briefing, Chinese SIM card registration, local payment systems setup (WeChat Pay & Alipay), and daily life tips for living in Nantong.
2	Program Orientation Meeting	<i>July 1</i>	Official program kickoff meeting with the full PnP Nantong team. Program roadmap, expectations, weekly milestones, and communication protocols. Includes Q&A session with program leads.
3	1-on-1 Meetings with PnP Program Lead	<i>July 3 & 6</i>	Individual onboarding sessions for each startup with the program lead to align goals, identify priorities, and review China entry strategy and key focus areas.
4	Program Kickoff Roadshow Event	<i>July 7</i>	Flagship launch event bringing together local founders, government officials from NETDA, NID, and NHIZ, industrial parks, and Nantong corporate partners. Includes networking sessions and ecosystem introductions.
5	Legal Entity Registration	<i>July 1 – 10</i>	Full document collection, preparation, translation, notarization, and submission for WFOE registration in Nantong. PnP team provides hands-on guidance throughout. Target: business license received by end of Week 1.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. Fully settled into housing and office workspace in Nantong
2. Program orientation completed and 1-on-1 onboarding sessions done
3. Strong first-impression networking at the Kickoff Roadshow with NETDA, NID, NHIZ, and local corporates.
4. All documents submitted for legal entity registration
5. Business license received — legal presence in China established

WEEK 2

July 13 – 17

Legal, Financial & Operational Setup

Activities

1	Banking Workshop & Bank Visit	July 13 – 14	Structured workshop covering corporate bank account opening in China, operating funds management, and international banking systems. Includes Q&A with a local banking expert. Followed by an in-person bank visit and account opening session.
2	Financial & Taxation Mentorship Session	July 15	Expert-led workshop on China's tax structure, accounting practices, cross-border fund flow, and payroll models for foreign-owned entities. Full Q&A with a local financial and taxation specialist.
3	Shanghai Business Trip	July 15 – 17	Business trip to Shanghai for ecosystem networking, partner introductions, and meetings with key players in the Yangtze River Delta innovation ecosystem. Domestic travel organized and arranged by the PnP team.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. Corporate bank account successfully opened and fully operational
2. Clear understanding of China's banking, taxation, and cross-border fund flow structure
3. Financial and accounting model established for the China entity
4. Shanghai ecosystem connections made and partnership opportunities explored

WEEK 3

July 20 – 24

Talent Access & Government Incentives

Activities

1	Government Grants & Subsidies Workshop	July 20	Comprehensive workshop on government fund availability across NETDA, NID, and NHIZ districts — covering eligibility criteria, application steps, timelines, and required documentation. Includes Q&A with government officials from the Talent and Technology Departments.
2	Visa & Work Permit Legal Workshop	July 21	Legal workshop covering foreigner talent visas, work permits, residence permits, and long-term stay regulations in China. Includes Q&A session with a legal expert specializing in foreign talent mobility.
3	Policy Matching & Document Preparation	July 20 – 24	1-on-1 policy matching sessions with the PnP team and district representatives to identify the best-fitting government programs for each startup. Document preparation begins immediately following selection.

4	Housing & Office Subsidy Applications	July 20 – 24	Introduction to government-subsidized long-term housing and larger office spaces available through NETDA, NID, and NHIZ. Negotiations and formal applications initiated based on each company's needs.
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Important — About Government Talent Programs

All talent grant and subsidy programs are government-administered through NETDA, NID, and NHIZ. Plug and Play China will work closely with you to identify the best-matching program and provide full application support. However, final decisions are made exclusively by the relevant government authorities — PnP cannot guarantee approval. The application process typically takes up to one year from submission to receiving the grant. We strongly encourage starting early.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. Clear understanding of all available government grants and subsidy programs across NETDA, NID, and NHIZ
2. Best-fitting policy options identified per startup, document preparation underway
3. Visa, work permit, and long-term residence requirements fully understood
4. Housing and office subsidy applications initiated where applicable
5. Direct relationships established with government talent and technology department officials

WEEK 4

July 27 – 31

Ecosystem Integration & POC Preparation

Activities

1	Cultural Trip	July 24 – 25	A curated cultural experience organized by the PnP team for the cohort to explore local culture, relax, and build community within the group. A great opportunity to connect beyond the program context.
2	City Tour & Local Business Communities	July 27	Guided city tour of Nantong covering key districts, NETDA, NID, and NHIZ followed by introductory meetings with local business communities and key ecosystem stakeholders.
3	Partner Scouting & Pitch Deck Adaptation	July 27 – 31	Research and identify target corporate partners and potential POC collaborators within Nantong's local ecosystem. Adapt pitch decks, pricing strategy, and initial proposals for Chinese market audiences. First outreach initiated.
4	Family, Healthcare & Social Services Briefing	July 27 – 31	Informational briefing on healthcare services, medical insurance options, social services, family resources, and international school and education options available to foreigners in Nantong. Includes Q&A with a local relocation support specialist.
5	Wenzhou Business Trip	July 30 – 31	Business trip to Wenzhou for ecosystem exposure and partnership exploration with local industrial and innovation stakeholders. Domestic travel fully organized and arranged by the PnP team.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. Target POC partners identified — outreach initiated and first responses received
2. Pitch deck and proposals adapted and ready for Chinese corporate audiences
3. Strong local business community connections built across NETDA, NID, and NHIZ
4. Family and lifestyle support resources understood and arranged where needed
5. Wenzhou ecosystem connections established

PHASE 2 — MARKET ENTRY | Weeks 5–8 | August 3 – August 28

WEEK 5

August 3 – 7

From Technology to Real Use Cases

Activities

1	Market Entry Workshop & Mentorship	<i>August 3</i>	Structured workshop on China market entry strategy, consumer behavior, local competitive landscape, and go-to-market approaches tailored to each focus vertical. Includes Q&A with an experienced China market mentor.
2	IP, Data & Patent Protection Workshop	<i>August 4</i>	Expert-led workshop on China IP strategy, patent filing and protection, technology confidentiality agreements, data compliance under Chinese law, and open-source risk management. Full Q&A with a specialist IP and legal expert.
3	POC Partner Scouting & Outreach	<i>August 3 – 7</i>	Active scouting of POC candidates, soft negotiations, site visits to potential partner facilities, and formal invitations extended for the POC Kickoff Session in Week 6.
4	POC Intent Letter Signing	<i>August 3 – 7</i>	Finalize and sign initial POC intent letters with confirmed partners ahead of the Kickoff Session. PnP team supports drafting and review.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. China market entry strategy clearly defined for each startup
2. Full understanding of IP protection, patent filing, and data compliance in China
3. POC partner shortlist finalized — invitations confirmed for Kickoff Session
4. First POC intent letters signed with early-confirmed partners

WEEK 6

August 10 – 14

POC Kickoff & Corporate Matchmaking

Activities

1	POC Kickoff Session (Flagship Event)	<i>August 10 – 11</i>	Major matchmaking event with NETDA, NID, and NHIZ corporate partners, industrial park representatives, potential POC collaborators, and suppliers. Includes structured pitch sessions, MOU and intent letter signings, and curated networking. Q&A panels with industry experts and government officials.
2	Closed-Door Individual Matchmaking Sessions	<i>August 10 – 14</i>	Private, closed-door 1-on-1 matchmaking sessions between each startup and their most relevant potential partners. Partners are shortlisted and curated jointly by the PnP team and the startups themselves, ensuring maximum relevance and fit.
3	Talent Subsidy Document Follow-Up	<i>August 10 – 14</i>	Follow-up on government talent subsidy applications initiated in Week 3. Document finalization, submission support, and status review with district officials.
4	POC Intent Letters & Partnership Proposals	<i>August 10 – 14</i>	Continue signing POC intent letters and develop first-draft partnership proposals based on Kickoff Session outcomes and individual matchmaking feedback.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. POC Kickoff Session successfully executed with strong attendance from NETDA, NID, NHIZ, and corporate partners
2. First round of closed-door 1-on-1 matchmaking sessions completed
3. MOUs and POC intent letters signed with key partners
4. Talent subsidy documents in final submission stage
5. First partnership proposals drafted, shared, and under active discussion

WEEK 7

August 17 – 21

Negotiations, Go-to-Market & Pilot Testing

Activities

1	Ongoing POC Negotiations	<i>August 17 – 21</i>	Continued closed-door negotiation sessions with shortlisted partners. Focus on deal structure, pilot scope, timeline, and commercial terms. PnP team facilitates and supports throughout.
2	China Market Case Studies Mentor Session	<i>August 17 – 21</i>	Mentor-led deep-dive into real China market case studies from international startups in similar verticals — covering localization successes, common pitfalls, and proven strategies. Includes open Q&A with experienced mentors.

3	Go-to-Market Strategy Workshop	August 17 – 21	Structured workshop to develop and refine each startup's China-specific go-to-market plan, sales strategy, channel approach, and pricing model. Includes Q&A with a China GTM specialist.
4	Ongoing Individual Matchmaking Sessions	August 17 – 21	Additional curated matchmaking sessions for startups requiring further partner introductions or second-round meetings with shortlisted prospects.
5	Out-of-Town Business Trip	August 17 – 21	Business trip to a key industrial or innovation hub in the region for ecosystem exposure and partnership development. Destination confirmed based on each startup's vertical focus. Domestic travel fully organized by the PnP team.
6	Pilot Testing & Product Validation	August 17 – 21	Initiate pilot testing and early product validation activities with confirmed POC partners. First structured feedback loop established with partner teams.

✦ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

1. Active POC negotiations underway with at least 2–3 confirmed partners per startup
2. China-specific go-to-market strategy finalized and ready for execution
3. Pilot testing initiated with at least one POC partner
4. Localization lessons from case studies applied to product and sales approach
5. Business trip completed — new ecosystem connections and partnership opportunities identified

WEEK 8

August 24 – 28

Business Model Validation & Deal Closing

Activities

1	Business Model Validation Workshop	August 24 – 28	Workshop to validate and refine each startup's China-adapted business model using real market feedback from partners, pilot results, and customer interactions. Includes revenue model review, pricing adjustments, and value proposition refinement. Q&A with industry experts and mentors.
2	Ongoing POC Matchmaking Sessions	August 24 – 28	Continued POC matchmaking for startups expanding their partner pipeline or requiring additional introduction rounds before Month 3.
3	Partnership Finalization & Deal Closing	August 24 – 28	Finalize partnership structures, close key agreements, and sign formal cooperation contracts with primary POC partners. PnP team supports legal review and negotiation.
4	Product Testing, Supplier Matching & Localization Planning	August 24 – 28	Ongoing product pilot testing with active partner feedback. Supplier matchmaking for startups requiring local manufacturing or sourcing support. Begin planning product localization and local development roadmap.

◆ Weekly Goals & Potential Outcomes

- China-adapted business model validated with real market and partner feedback
- Key POC partnerships formally closed with signed cooperation agreements
- Supplier and manufacturing network established where applicable
- Product pilot testing ongoing with structured partner feedback loop
- Startup is operationally embedded in Nantong's local innovation ecosystem

WHAT COMES NEXT | Months 3 – 6

Month 3	Localization & Validation, Deep POC execution, product and business model localization, market traction building, IP protection finalization, and ongoing partner expansion.
Month 4	Investor Readiness, Fundraising strategy workshops, refining your China growth narrative, financial modeling sessions, investor materials and bilingual pitch deck preparation. Soft introductions to our investor network begin.
Month 5	Fundraising Acceleration , Closed-door fundraising roundtables with the PnP venture team, partner VCs, local investors, and government investment representatives. Roadshows, warm introductions, and term sheet discussions.
Month 6	Demo Day & Graduation, Final Demo Day presentation to investors, corporates, and government stakeholders. Staff recruitment support, university partnerships, intern hiring, and alumni network integration. Post-program development path confirmed.

FINANCIAL SUPPORT SUMMARY

The following financial support is available to all selected startups. Support is provided per startup, not per individual team member. All reimbursements require the submission of supporting documents as specified below.

International Flight Subsidy | Up to USD 2,000 per startup

1. Capped at USD 2,000 total per startup, applies to one or more team members traveling to China for the program
2. To claim: submit your flight invoice and proof of payment along with your Chinese registered company legal entity documents
3. Promised reimbursement timeline: within 3 months of submission, in practice this usually takes 25–30 business days
4. Reimbursement is processed to your corporate or personal bank account after internal verification

Housing Subsidy | Up to RMB 2,000 per startup per month

1. Covers a one-bedroom apartment in Nantong, approximately 70 square meters, which typically rents for around RMB 1,800/month
2. The PnP team assists in identifying suitable apartments near the program hub before your arrival
3. To claim: submit your signed rental contract and official invoice each month with your Chinese business license
4. Same reimbursement process and timeline as flight subsidy, typically 25–30 business days after submission

Free Workspace | Complimentary

1. One complimentary dedicated workstation at the Plug and Play Nantong hub for the full duration of the program

2. Access to meeting rooms, printing, and common facilities at the hub

Government Talent Programs | Up to €120,000 (varies by program)

1. All talent grant and subsidy programs are fully government-administered through NETDA, NID, and NHIZ districts, not directly provided by Plug and Play China
2. After joining the program, the PnP team will assess your profile and identify the best-matching government program for your startup and team
3. PnP provides full application support, including document preparation, coaching, and submission but final approval decisions rest solely with the government authorities
4. Important: the application and review process typically takes up to one year from submission to receiving the grant. We strongly encourage early action

Seed Investment | Possible RMB 100,000 from Plug and Play China

1. Upon graduating the program, selected startups may receive a seed round investment of RMB 100,000 from Plug and Play China.
2. This is a performance-based outcome and not guaranteed, startups are evaluated throughout the program by the PnP venture team during events, roadshows, and Demo Day

Broader Investment Opportunities | Possible outcome, not a guarantee

1. Throughout and after the program, startups may receive investment interest from the PnP venture team, local Nantong investors, PnP partner VCs, strategic corporate partners, and government-backed investment funds
2. These are genuine possibilities that arise through the program's ecosystem access and exposure, they are not guaranteed outcomes, but represent realistic paths for high-performing startups
3. The stronger your China traction, validated business model, and partner relationships, the higher your chances of attracting investment conversations

Questions? We are here for you.

Abolfazl Abedini (Aboli) | International Affairs & Operation Manager
Aboli@pnpchina.com | +86-15515532656 | WeChat: 15515532656
pnpchina.com | playbook.pnpchina.com